

KCTC MEMBERSHIP MEETING 1-18-2026

Bonnie Thomas, Dan Goldberg, Lauren Paddick, Linda Irwin, Donna Rotoloni, Chris Palamone, Juanita Martini, Lynda Kuzbel, Mary Beneditti, Pam Heidrich, Susan Wetherell, Brendon Connolly, Maria Vighetti, Suzanne Vighetti, Erika Dreikorn, Maribeth Hook, Tracey Miller, Virginia Weida, Clemence Cretaux, Sarah Mangan, Sharon Hareza, Amy Rusenko, Pam Lewis, Amy Sandhagen, Ted Nowlen, Bill Tullock, Morga Shipley, Katie Hinzman, Clara Marie Schmalz, Michelle Rengers

CALL TO ORDER:

Ted Nowlen called the meeting to order. 7:00 PM

Minutes from the November 18, 2026 meeting were approved.

TREASURER'S REPORT

11/30/2025

Previous Balance \$56,029.08

Deposits \$295.00

Checks and Payments \$5263.53

Ending Balance \$51,060.55

12/31/2025

Previous Balance \$51,060.55

Deposits \$11,698.64

Checks and Payments \$8,600.99

Ending Balance \$54,158.20

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

7 new members were presented for membership.

Ana Lucia Arita, Linda Joyce & Jaclyn Joyce & Joe Alden, Mallory Mallow, Sarah Mangan, Lauren Paddick

TRAINING DIRECTOR'S REPORT

- Most classes are full
- WCRL Trial May 16 & 17, is not on the calendar; it is on the home page, and details will be there when the premium is available
- Waitlist has been reduced by the 2 class limit

NOMINATING COMMITTEE REPORT

- Bill Tullock is the chair, please reach out to him with nominees
- Nominations are in March for the election in May
- The following position will be in the upcoming election
 - Vice-President
 - Corresponding Secretary/Membership Chair
 - Training Director
 - Director-at-Large (one of the two elected positions)

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

- Bathroom door was temporarily down and it has been replaced
 - Thank you, Amy, for painting
- Change to the Calendar; covered by Pam

Upcoming Trials/Events

- Nothing yet on the schedule, the trials will appear on the home page of the website

New Business

- Green room ventilation is complete, this will prevent mildew buildup

New Business

- Upcoming Revision to Bylaws and Policies and Procedures
 - It has been cleaned up and corrected (Bonus Bones, K9ers and bad wording are examples)
 - Will be available within the next few weeks and will be voted on by Membership
- Floor cleaning will be the week of March 2
 - The first week after the end of the session will be left open for make-up classes
 - The building will be shut down the first week of March

President's Thank Yous

- Cindy Sumner for the Holiday Party, including the amount of room for people and the place itself. There will be a little bit of an increase next year.

AROUND THE ROOM

- Suzanne Vighetti – voiced her concerns
 - Attended previous meeting with positive (appreciation of the potty area, wifi, toilet seat and a suggestion for on-line meetings)
 - Tonight, the treatment of others, leading to members resigning from their volunteer position, others not coming to class, being the topic of an online post, a member who voiced concern over canine member treatment, her concern was dismissed
 - Here to seek a solution and support, all members are volunteers, keep classes positive and care for our canine members

- Does the club use positive training methods, is it in the Bylaws
 - An event occurred where a dog on a lease lunged at a class member (dog), it was brought to the attention of the instructor and the person said they were belittled, followed by nasty emails.
 - During the meeting it was shared that the person with the dog who lunged was dismissed from the class and advised to seek professional help by the instructor

The discussion from the event included many members with the goal to address the issues brought forward as a club.

Suggestions included:

- Susan Wetherell reviewed the Bylaws, and there was no definition of positive reinforcement training regarding human to dog treatment.
 - Agreed Susan will review definitions for clarity on dog to dog, dog to human, human to dog and send them to the board
- Kindness to members (between members)
 - Clem Cretaux shared her experience after acknowledging the concern from the event. She received an email and resigned her position as Vice President immediately. She will continue with the newsletter
 - Others voiced suggestions about more member involvement
 - To further provide examples of treatment Moragn Shipley shared an experience of being told her dog (non-reactive) couldn't come to class
 - Suggestion of more verbal (person-to-person) communication, and less email (Chris Palamone))
 - Transparency and accountability for all so that the environment would allow for people to enjoy time with their dogs (Katie Hinzman)

Board President responded

- We are here to have time with our dogs
- The instructor's response was the only appropriate reaction available under the circumstances, and no alternative response would have been more suitable
- The student's reaction was disproportionate and included comments that unfairly demeaned the instructor in front of the other students
- The incident was escalated beyond its actual significance, and any interactions were not intended to cause the response that resulted
- The discussion initiated the opportunity to review the instructor manual
 - Susan Wetherell volunteered to help provide 'positive reinforcement' definitions for the bylaws and review the instructor manual

Agreement to move forward

ADJOURNMENT 7:46 PM

Respectfully Submitted
Michelle Rengers, Recording Secretary